

Start with the job

An expense assistant should help resolve a request. “Use an agent” does not explain the job.

Separate the fixed rules

A spending limit can be checked in code. A model does not need to reinterpret it on every run.

Find the uncertain decision

An unclear description may need interpretation or another question. Name what information would resolve it.

Bound the action

Preparing a recommendation and authorising a payment carry different responsibilities.
Define each permission.

Decide how to check it

Use cases with known outcomes,
review ambiguous cases and test
what happens when evidence is
missing.

Review your own workflow

Which steps need interpretation?
Which need tools? Which can stay deterministic?

Illustrative teaching example.

Review your design